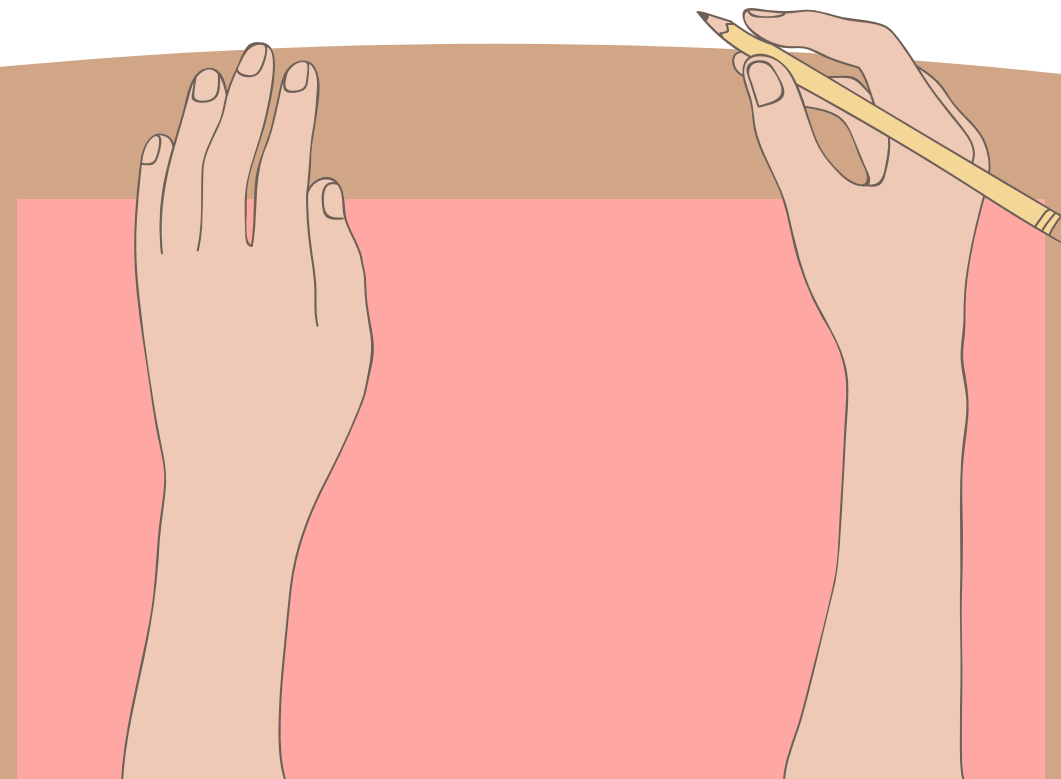
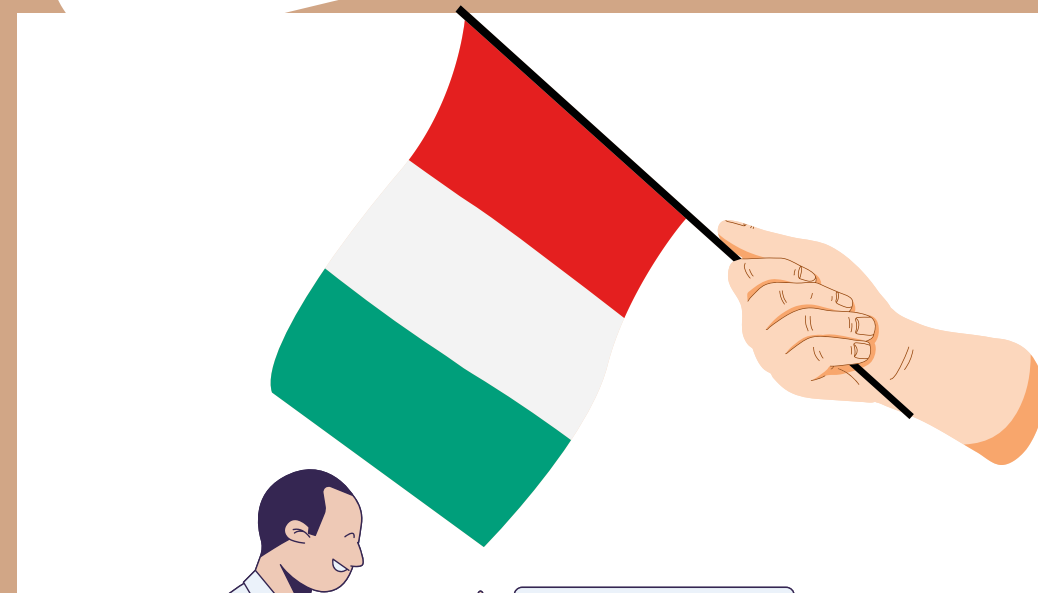


ITALIAN NON-VERBAL COMMUNICATION

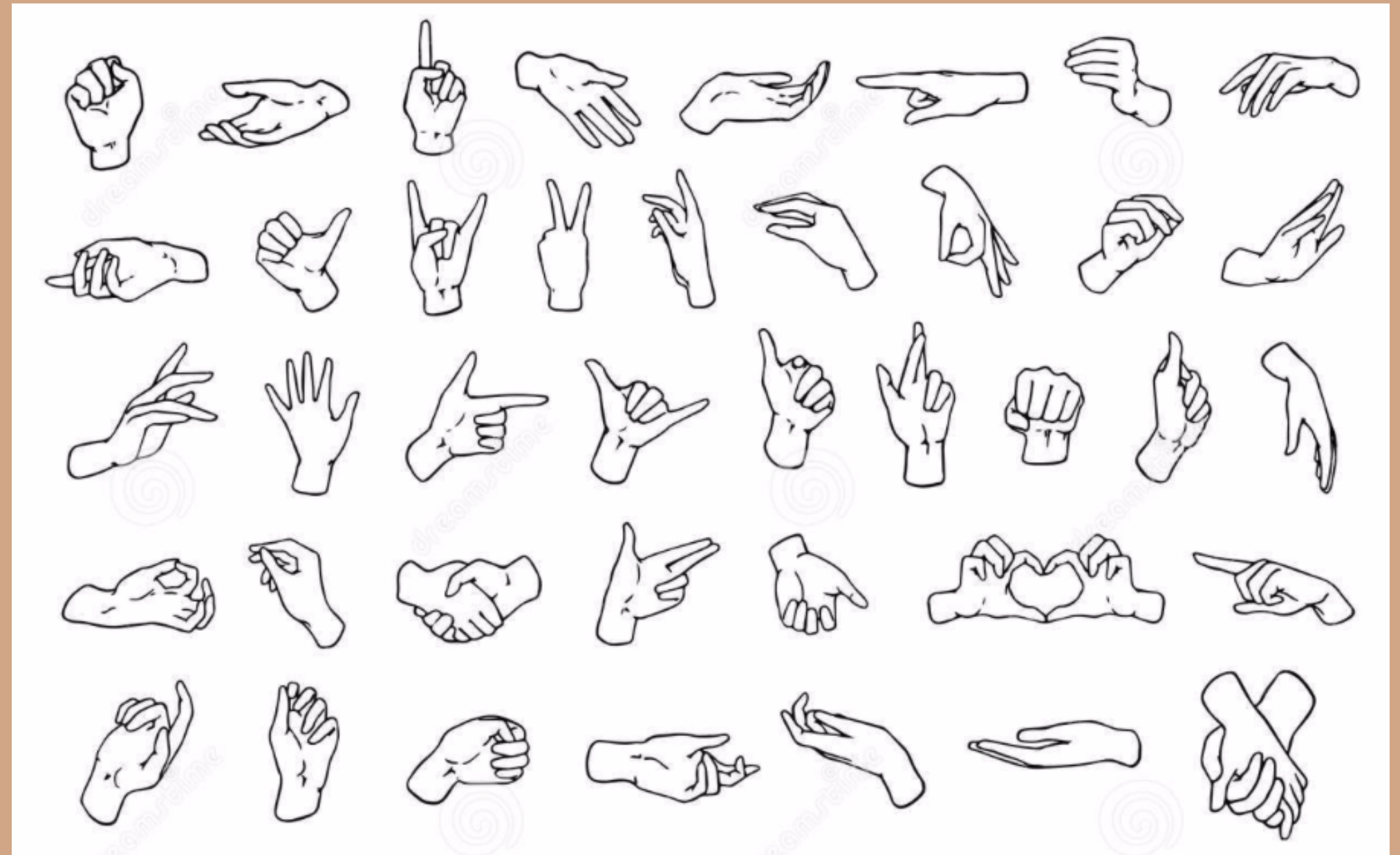


THE NON-VERBAL COMMUNICATION



When human beings communicate, they also use the body: it is the so-called non-verbal communication. When we speak, in fact, we also use the head, the hands, the gaze and even the legs.

Italians, in particular, are known all over the world to express themselves through gestures.



THE LEVELS OF COMMUNICATION

To clarify the concept:

- **verbal communication** concerns the transmission of the message's content;
- **paraverbal communication** treats the volume, tone, rhythm, pitch and timbre of the voice;
- **non-verbal communication** concerns mimicry, gestures and posture.





EXAMPLES OF NON-VERBAL COMMUNICATION

There are different classifications of gestures:

- Iconic gestures
- Co-verbal gestures
- Symbolic gestures
- Gestures related to some specific cultural identities





WHY DO WE NEED TO EXPRESS OURSELVES IN GESTURES?



Gestures are means for expressing complex and abstract ideas which are immediately perceived by the interlocutor



They can draw the attention of the interlocutor to relevant elements for communication



Gestures would also play a very important role for memory and learning

AN ITALIAN PECULIARITY?



Gestures are observed in all human communities but each community develops its own "sign code". This is why a common gesture within a certain culture has a clear interpretation, but for another culture it may not have the same meaning.

It seems, then, that some cultures must be considered more "gestural" than others. For example, Italians are known for "talking with hands".

The relationship between gestures and Italians is so particular as to intrigue foreigners.



HISTORICAL ROOTS OF ITALIAN GESTURES



SOME THEORIES:

- It was the Greeks who introduced the marked gestures of Italian language colonizing the southern Italy.
- Communicating with gestures meant not being understood by the dominant populations (Romans, Goths, Normans and all those who dominated the peninsula). Gestures therefore replaced the word as a sort of code language.
- Since communities spoke different dialects before linguistic unity, gestures helped to understand each other more easily.
- The Commedia dell'Arte, theatrical expression born in Italy, enhanced the mimicry and gestures of comic art. The gestures used were integrated into daily talk.

And to make fun of Italian habits, here is the rap video released by the American Consulate:



<https://youtu.be/v2Y-L-dKeEo>

THANK YOU FOR THE ATTENTION!

